

Fallen Tribes - Council Archives

The Thallian Nebula: Setting Overview

The Thallian Nebula is a dense, chaotic region of space filled with swirling cosmic dust, vibrant ion storms, and mysterious ancient ruins scattered across its many star systems. Unlike typical nebulas, the Thallian Nebula is unique in that stellar distances are incredibly short, with many star systems packed closely together, making travel between them relatively quick. However, the nebula's dense clouds and unpredictable gravitational anomalies make navigation treacherous, often requiring specialized ships and seasoned pilots.

The nebula is home to a diverse range of celestial bodies, from resource-rich planets to barren moons, each offering its own strategic value or hidden dangers. Ancient megastructures and derelict stations dot the landscape, remnants of a forgotten civilization that once thrived here. The nebula is also the site of frequent skirmishes and covert operations as various factions vie for control, resources, and influence.

Factions, Homeworlds, and Points of Interest

1. Kareth Nara (Karisen Natives)



Ideology: *Natural Sovereignty*

Interdependencies: The Kareth Nara claim the Thallian Nebula as their sacred homeland, believing their divine birthright extends beyond its borders. They are deeply protective of this region, considering it their duty to preserve the nebula's sanctity and natural balance against external threats, particularly the encroaching Terrans.

Homeworld: *Kar-Sekir*

Description: Kar-Sekir is a lush, verdant world deep within the heart of the nebula, teeming with life and covered in vast forests, towering mountains, and sacred sites. The planet's atmosphere is thick with the energies of the nebula, creating unique weather patterns and bioluminescent flora. The Kareth Nara consider this world their holy land, with ancient temples and natural formations revered as sacred.

Points of Interest:

- **The Crystal Spires:** Massive crystalline formations that jut out from the planet's surface, believed to be conduits of spiritual energy.
- **The Venerated Forest:** A vast, ancient forest where the Kareth Nara conduct their most sacred rituals.
- **The Whispering Canyons:** Deep canyons where the winds carry the voices of the ancestors, considered a place of meditation and communion with the past.

2. Terra Nexum (Terran)



Ideology: *Human Ascendancy*

Interdependencies: The Terrans are near-extinct refugees who see the Thallian Nebula as their last hope for survival. Forced to settle in this foreign land, they must navigate the delicate balance between respecting the Kareth Nara's claim and asserting their own need to rebuild their civilization.

Homeworld: *New Horizon*

Description: New Horizon is a recently colonized world on the outskirts of the nebula, with sprawling plains, arid deserts, and rugged mountain ranges. It has a harsh, unforgiving climate, reminiscent of the Old West, with dusty towns and frontier settlements scattered across its surface. The Terrans are working hard to terraform the planet, but progress is slow, and life here is tough and gritty.

Points of Interest:

- **Frontier Station:** A bustling hub of trade and commerce, where settlers and prospectors gather to trade goods, share news, and seek fortune.
- **The Dust Bowl:** A vast desert region, home to dangerous wildlife and outlaw hideouts, but also rich in rare minerals.
- **Rust Valley:** A canyon filled with the wreckage of old ships and vehicles, now repurposed into makeshift settlements and fortresses.

Secondary Worlds:

- **Dustwind:** A desert planet with a neo-western vibe, known for its lawless towns and mining outposts.
- **Ironreach:** A mountainous world rich in metal ores, with mining towns clinging to the cliffs and a network of railways connecting the settlements.

3. Consortium Galactica (Galactic Council)



Ideology: *Universal Order*

Interdependencies: The Consortium Galactica seeks to maintain balance and order within the nebula, ensuring that no single faction grows too powerful or faces extinction. They act as peacekeepers, though their distant and bureaucratic approach often results in unintended consequences, frustrating those who desire more direct action.

Homeworld: *Astralis Prime*

Description: Astralis Prime is a gleaming, heavily fortified world that serves as the central seat of power for the Galactic Council. The planet is covered in sprawling cities, massive spaceports, and the towering spires of the Council's headquarters. The atmosphere is a constant buzz of activity, with fleets of ships arriving and departing from the planet's many orbital stations.

Points of Interest:

- **The Council Spire:** The towering central building where the Council convenes, visible from anywhere on the planet.
- **The Stellar Archives:** A massive repository of knowledge, containing data on every known civilization, star system, and law in the galaxy.
- **Orbital Citadels:** A network of heavily armed space stations that protect the planet from any potential threats.

4. Illumaria (Benefactor)



Ideology: *Guided Enlightenment*

Interdependencies: The Illumaria operate as shadowy manipulators, profiting from the chaos and disputes within the nebula. They believe in shaping the course of events to their advantage, often through espionage and destabilization, while ensuring that no faction gains too much power or stability.

Homeworld: *Illuma*

Description: Illuma is a shadowy, industrialized world, cloaked in perpetual twilight due to its thick atmosphere. The planet's surface is covered in sprawling megacities and underground

complexes where the Illumaria conduct their secretive operations. The planet's true nature is hidden beneath layers of deception, with most of its activities occurring in the shadows.

Points of Interest:

- **The Black Markets:** A vast network of underground markets where anything can be bought or sold, from weapons to information.
- **The Silent Citadel:** The hidden headquarters of the Illumaria, a fortress of secrecy and intrigue.
- **The Shade Zones:** Areas of the planet perpetually shrouded in darkness, where the most clandestine operations take place.

5. Astryn'Vel (Rebels)



Ideology: *Freedom Through Defiance*

Interdependencies: The Astryn'Vel seek to liberate the nebula from the oppressive control of the Galactic Council, believing that the Council's meddling has caused untold suffering. They strive to eliminate all Council presence and turn the nebula into a free state where each faction can govern itself.

Homeworld: *Vespera*

Description: Vespera is a hidden, remote world deep within the nebula, covered in dense forests and rugged terrain. It serves as the secret base of operations for the Astryn'Vel, with settlements and bases concealed from prying eyes. The planet's landscape is wild and untamed, much like the rebels who call it home.

Points of Interest:

- **Echo Base:** The primary stronghold of the Astryn'Vel, hidden deep within a mountain range and protected by advanced cloaking technology.
- **The Freehold:** A sprawling underground city where rebel leaders meet and plan their operations.
- **The Whispering Plains:** An open, wind-swept region where the rebels test their stealth technology and train new recruits.

6. Ezrathi (Cultists)



Ideology: *Void Reverence*

Interdependencies: The Ezrathi are driven by an ancient prophecy, believing that a powerful race responsible for the ancient megastructures will one day return. Their ideology is centered on unlocking these ancient secrets through ritual and sacrifice, believing that they are destined to harness this power and rule the nebula.

Homeworld: *Nekros*

Description: Nekros is a dark, foreboding world on the edge of the nebula, covered in ancient ruins and strange, otherworldly landscapes. The planet is steeped in mystery, with many believing it to be a place of great power and danger. The Ezrathi have turned this world into their center of worship and ritual, conducting dark ceremonies to awaken the ancient powers they seek.

Points of Interest:

- **The Black Monoliths:** Mysterious structures of unknown origin that emit a faint, ominous energy, believed to be key to the Ezrathi's rituals.
- **The Void Temple:** The central religious site of the Ezrathi, where sacrifices and ceremonies are performed.
- **The Catacombs of the Ancients:** A vast underground network of tunnels and chambers, filled with relics and secrets from a bygone era.

7. Kri'thul (Plague)



Ideology: *Inevitable Corruption*

Interdependencies: The Kri'thul believe that the nebula, and the galaxy at large, is beyond saving. Their ideology is one of ultimate destruction, seeing their role as agents of the end, destined to bring about the collapse of all civilizations through chaos and death.

Homeworld: *Viroth*

Description: Viroth is a decaying, blighted world consumed by corruption and death. The planet's surface is a twisted landscape of dying forests, polluted seas, and decaying cities, all

slowly succumbing to the plague that the Kri'thul believe to be their calling. It is a world that few dare to approach, with an atmosphere that reeks of death and despair.

Points of Interest:

- **The Rotting Spires:** Towers of decayed metal and stone, remnants of a once-great civilization now overtaken by the plague.
- **The Blight Sea:** A vast, toxic ocean that stretches across much of the planet, filled with mutated creatures and foul waters.
- **The Wailing Pit:** A massive chasm that is said to be the source of the plague, with strange, haunting sounds emanating from its depths.

8. Shadur'kai (Rogue)



Ideology: *Shadowed Autonomy*

Interdependencies: The Shadur'kai exist to counteract the influence of the Illumaria and hold the Galactic Council accountable. Their ideology centers on the idea of autonomy and justice, but through covert means. They aim to maintain balance in the nebula by preventing any faction from gaining too much control.

Homeworld: *Shadowfall*

Description: Shadowfall is a cloaked, hidden world on the fringes of the nebula, known only to the Shadur'kai. The planet is shrouded in secrecy, with its surface covered in dense forests, misty valleys, and shadowy mountains. The Shadur'kai have established hidden bases and outposts across the planet, using it as a staging ground for their covert operations.

Points of Interest:

- **The Veil:** A massive shroud of mist and electromagnetic interference that hides the planet from detection, making it nearly impossible to find without specific coordinates.
- **The Silent Forest:** A vast, eerie forest where the Shadur'kai conduct their training and maintain their hidden archives.
- **The Shadowspire:** The central command center of the Shadur'kai, hidden deep within the mountains and protected by layers of advanced security.

Other Points of Interest in the Thallian Nebula:

- **The Ancient Ring:** A colossal ring-shaped megastructure orbiting a distant star, believed to be a relic of the ancient civilization that once inhabited the nebula. It is a place of great mystery and power, attracting explorers, cultists, and scholars alike.
- **The Maelstrom:** A swirling vortex of energy and gravitational anomalies located at the nebula's core. It is considered extremely dangerous, with few ships ever returning from its depths. It is rumored to be connected to the ancient technology scattered throughout the nebula.
- **The Ghost Fleet:** A collection of derelict ships drifting aimlessly through a remote part of the nebula. These ships are believed to be haunted or cursed, and many believe they are tied to the Kri'thul's ancient plague.

Astronomical Overview of the Thallian Nebula

Location:

The Thallian Nebula is located in a remote sector on the outer edge of one of the galaxy's spiral arms. This dense and turbulent region spans approximately 100 light-years and is characterized by cosmic dust clouds, ion storms, and ancient megastructures. The nebula's central feature is a massive black hole, the remnant of a red giant that collapsed around 1 billion years ago, disrupting the surrounding space and leaving a ring of stellar systems in its wake.

Central Massive Black Hole and Surrounding Star Systems

The Thallian Nebula's black hole is a gravitational anchor for several key star systems, each home to important factions vying for control, survival, and dominance within the nebula.

Core Star Systems and Homeworlds

1. Alpha Thallius (Astralis Prime - Galactic Council)

Star Type: G-type main-sequence star (Sun-like)

Age: 4.2 billion years

Planets: 7 (2 habitable)

Homeworld: *Astralis Prime*

- **Diameter:** 13,000 km
- **Gravity:** 1.02 G

- **Temperature Range:** 10°C to 35°C (Moderate)
- **Climate:** Temperate with well-distributed rainfall, mild seasons.
- **Key Features:**
 - **Ruins of the Ancients:** Scattered across the northern continent, these ancient structures are heavily guarded and studied by the Galactic Council.
 - **Population:** 10.8 billion
 - **Major Biomes:** Mixed forests, expansive plains, freshwater lakes.
 - **Special Importance:** *Stellar Archives* - Astralis Prime houses the largest repository of knowledge in the galaxy, the Stellar Archives, containing data on all known civilizations and star systems.
 - **Weather Patterns:** Generally stable, with occasional strong storms driven by oceanic currents and mountain ranges.

Jump Point Alpha: A major "Jump" point used by the Galactic Council, facilitating rapid transit between the nebula's core systems and the wider galaxy.

2. Beta Thallius (Kar-Sekir - Kareth Nara)

Star Type: F-type main-sequence star

Age: 3.8 billion years

Planets: 5 (1 habitable)

Homeworld: *Kar-Sekir*

- **Diameter:** 14,500 km
- **Gravity:** 0.98 G
- **Temperature Range:** 5°C to 28°C (Cool to Moderate)
- **Climate:** Lush, temperate climate with heavy rainfall and frequent mist.
- **Key Features:**
 - **The Venerated Forest:** An ancient, bioluminescent forest that covers much of the planet, considered sacred by the Kareth Nara.
 - **Population:** 2.5 billion
 - **Major Biomes:** Dense rainforests, misty mountains, bioluminescent swamps.
 - **Special Importance:** *Crystal Spires* - Massive crystalline formations that grow naturally across the landscape, believed to be conduits of spiritual energy by the Kareth Nara.
 - **Weather Patterns:** Persistent mists and frequent light rain, with heavy seasonal storms driven by oceanic and atmospheric currents.

Jump Point Beta: A secondary "Jump" point used primarily by Kareth Nara spiritual emissaries and explorers.

3. Gamma Thallius (New Horizon - Terra Nexum)

Star Type: K-type main-sequence star (Orange dwarf)

Age: 2.7 billion years

Planets: 8 (2 habitable)

Homeworld: *New Horizon*

- **Diameter:** 12,800 km
- **Gravity:** 1.03 G
- **Temperature Range:** -15°C to 45°C (Hot to Cold extremes)
- **Climate:** Arid with vast deserts, dry grasslands, and high-altitude mountainous regions.
- **Key Features:**
 - **Frontier Settlements:** Scattered towns and cities resembling the Old West, with a mix of Terran technology and frontier life.
 - **Population:** 900 million
 - **Major Biomes:** Deserts, rugged mountains, sparse grasslands.
 - **Special Importance:** *Rust Valley* - A massive canyon filled with the wreckage of old ships and vehicles, now repurposed into settlements and fortresses by the Terrans.
 - **Weather Patterns:** Hot, dry summers with cool winters, prone to dust storms and droughts. Some regions experience flash floods during brief rainy seasons.

Jump Point Gamma: A well-guarded "Jump" point critical for supplying Terran settlements and maintaining their fragile foothold in the nebula.

4. Delta Thallius (Illuma - Illumaria)

Star Type: M-type main-sequence star (Red dwarf)

Age: 5.3 billion years

Planets: 3 (1 habitable)

Homeworld: *Illuma*

- **Diameter:** 9,600 km
- **Gravity:** 0.89 G
- **Temperature Range:** -50°C to 15°C (Cold to Cool)
- **Climate:** Perpetual twilight due to thick atmospheric haze, with constant cloud cover.
- **Key Features:**
 - **The Silent Citadel:** A massive fortress hidden beneath the planet's surface, serving as the headquarters for the Illumaria's espionage activities.
 - **Population:** 1.2 billion
 - **Major Biomes:** Cold tundras, industrial zones, underground cities.
 - **Special Importance:** *The Black Markets* - An expansive network of underground markets where anything can be bought or sold, providing the Illumaria with vast wealth and influence.

- **Weather Patterns:** Cold and damp, with frequent sleet and snow. The atmosphere traps heat, creating a greenhouse effect, but surface conditions remain harsh and inhospitable.

Jump Point Delta: A covert "Jump" point used by the Illumaria for rapid, secretive travel across the nebula.

5. Epsilon Thallius (Nekros - Ezrathi)

Star Type: Brown dwarf

Age: 4.9 billion years

Planets: 2 (1 habitable)

Homeworld: *Nekros*

- **Diameter:** 15,000 km
- **Gravity:** 1.08 G
- **Temperature Range:** -70°C to 10°C (Frigid)
- **Climate:** Dark and cold, with only infrared light penetrating the thick clouds and dense atmosphere.
- **Key Features:**
 - **The Void Temple:** The central religious site of the Ezrathi, where dark rituals are conducted to awaken the ancient powers they seek.
 - **Population:** 300 million
 - **Major Biomes:** Frozen wastelands, ash-covered plains, blackened forests.
 - **Special Importance:** *The Black Monoliths* - Mysterious structures of unknown origin, believed to be remnants of an ancient civilization with deep ties to the black hole.
 - **Weather Patterns:** Perpetually cold with icy winds and rare, brief warming periods when the atmosphere shifts, exposing the surface to the star's faint heat.

Jump Point Epsilon: A hazardous "Jump" point near the orbit of the black hole, used by the Ezrathi for their dark pilgrimages.

Additional Star Systems and Points of Interest

1. Zeta Thallius (Shadowfall - Shadur'kai)

Star Type: L-type brown dwarf

Age: 1.5 billion years

Planets: 3 (2 habitable)

Homeworld: *Shadowfall*

- **Diameter:** 11,200 km
- **Gravity:** 0.96 G

- **Temperature Range:** -30°C to 20°C (Cool)
- **Climate:** Dark and misty, with low light levels due to the faint star.
- **Key Features:**
 - **The Shadowspire:** The central command center of the Shadur'kai, hidden deep within the planet's mountains and protected by advanced security.
 - **Population:** 400 million
 - **Major Biomes:** Misty forests, shadowy mountains, underground rivers.
 - **Special Importance:** *The Veil* - A massive shroud of mist and electromagnetic interference that hides the planet from detection, making it nearly impossible to find without specific coordinates.
 - **Weather Patterns:** Cool and damp, with frequent fogs and mist that obscure the landscape. Occasional electromagnetic storms disrupt technology.

Jump Point Zeta: A highly secretive "Jump" point, known only to the Shadur'kai and used for clandestine operations.

2. Theta Thallius (Vespera - Astryn'Vel)

Star Type: K-type subgiant

Age: 3.6 billion years

Planets: 5 (1 habitable)

Homeworld: *Vespera*

- **Diameter:** 13,400 km
- **Gravity:** 1.05 G
- **Temperature Range:** -5°C to 25°C (Moderate)
- **Climate:** Cool temperate with dense forests and rugged terrain.
- **Key Features:**
 - **Echo Base:** The primary stronghold of the Astryn'Vel, hidden within a mountain range and protected by cloaking technology.
 - **Population:** 800 million
 - **Major Biomes:** Temperate forests, rocky mountains, underground caverns.
 - **Special Importance:** *The Freehold* - A sprawling underground city where rebel leaders meet and plan their operations, a symbol of resistance against the Galactic Council.
 - **Weather Patterns:** Mild seasons with frequent rain, especially in the mountains. Occasional snow at higher elevations.

Jump Point Theta: A heavily guarded "Jump" point used by the Astryn'Vel for their covert operations and supply routes.

Key Points of Interest in the Thallian Nebula

- **The Ancient Ring:** A colossal ring-shaped megastructure orbiting a distant star, believed to be a relic of the ancient civilization that once inhabited the nebula. It serves as both a strategic military outpost and a research facility.
- **The Maelstrom:** A swirling vortex of energy and gravitational anomalies located at the nebula's core, thought to be a remnant of the ancient civilization's technology. It is extremely dangerous, with few ships ever returning from its depths.
- **The Ghost Fleet:** A collection of derelict ships drifting aimlessly through the nebula, believed to be haunted or cursed. They are rumored to be tied to the Kri'thul's ancient plague and are a source of both fear and fascination.